

Adolf Hitler, Kaitlyn O'Neill

Adolf Hitler's influence, motivation and significance as a leader in Germany, especially during World War 2.

Adolf Hitler, the most historically destructive ruler.

“Humanitarianism is the expression of stupidity and cowardice.” – [Adolf Hitler](#)

-This quote representing the mindset possessed by Hitler which caused mass social, political and economic destruction in the **Second World War**. Hitler transformed Germany into a militaristic powerhouse during his time as leader [of Germany](#) from 1933-1945. The Second World War resulted in over 37 million civilian and military casualties having detrimental impacts globally. Hitler had a significant impact on a global scale, but particularly in Germany during his time as leader, causing havoc nationwide while committing unjustifiable acts resulting in the deaths of millions of people, violating basic human rights and exploiting many civilians through the use of violence and fear. His military prowess and obsession began during the First World War where he fought for Germany as a soldier. He gained nationalistic ideologies, and after Germany's defeat in the First World War he began plotting revenge after being in contradiction of the signing of the armistice and the Treaty of Versailles. Monarchy and its glory was thought to culminate after the abdication of Kaiser Wilhelm the second, and the creation of the Weimar republic, but evidently the creation of the Weimar Republic and the Weimar constitution along with its weaknesses gave Hitler the incentive and opportunity to overthrow the democratic system through the use of Article 48, ~~which was a set of emergency powers initially created to be used as protection,~~ but Hitler used it to create a totalitarian system. His motivation grew from his infatuation with Germany and his hate of communism, which he thought was a threat being imposed by the Jewish people, therefore being the reason of their demise during the Second World War. Hitler had a significant influence during 1933-1945, by rallying the entire nation to fight for his beliefs and by manipulating the public to share the same mindset as him. [Try to decrease the size of your intro to succinctly introduce the topic. Some of the information here can be placed in your body paragraphs.](#)

Hitler was born in 1889 in Braunau, Austria. He grew up in a stable family home with his father pursuing a career as a customs officer. Hitler was reluctant to follow in his father's footsteps as a civil servant which caused him to leave school after his father's death in 1903. He never was academically gifted and decided to pursue a pathway in art, but was rejected from Vienna's Academy of Fine Arts. After his mother's passing in 1908 he moved to Vienna, he made a living of painting and selling his images but he was barely getting by, as he isolated without his family he became an avid reader which is where his political interests and motivation sparked from. From this he developed many of the ideas that came to shape his Nazi ideology. As a young adult he showed early interest in German nationalism, often rejecting authorities, this nationalism would become the motivating force of Hitler's life. In 1913 when War broke Hitler relocated to Munich and enrolled as a soldier.

World War one broke out in Europe in 1914. Germany was one of the central powers within the first war and were heavily involved. The beginning of World War one had a huge impact

on Hitler's motivation and influences, at this time he was quite lost attempting to find a purpose in life and the war gave him direction, and he chose to commit himself completely to fighting for Germany, and with extremely nationalistic ideology's he began to have narcissistic viewpoints, especially towards communists. During the First World War Hitler served as a soldier for Germany [Explain why he served as a German soldier when he was Austrian](#), he faced many adversities but survived all accounts. He was promoted to the rank of corporal and considered a brave hero; he acquired a thirst for power which motivated him in the future having a large influence on his attitude and actions in World War Two. In 1918 Hitler was partially blinded and sent to a military hospital. Later that year after the November 11th signing of the armistice, he was informed that Germany had declared an ending and loss of the war. This left Hitler bitter as he felt as if the only community who ever gave him a purpose was demobilising and he would no longer have direction in life and career prospects.

Hitler like hundreds of thousands of other Germans [But Hitler was Austrian so why did he feel this way?](#) was disturbed by their nation's defeat in WW1, and were deeply unsettled by the new political revolution sweeping the nation. They were all looking for an answer. Hitler's solution to this answer was a political party that was already in existence, initially named the German Workers Party Hitler became a dominant public figure for the group due to his charismatic personality and his gift for public speaking. In the early 1920s, the group changed their name to the National Socialist German Workers' Party also referred to as the Nazi party. This movement gave somewhat of an explanation of Germany's defeat, this being a large reason it rallied a lot of support. He argued that the loss of the war was not due to former soldiers such as himself but rather seditious forces at home had undermined the war effort, and that explained why Germany had lost. That became the core of his message and the stab in the back myth arose. This myth was used as propaganda for the Nazis and other right-winged parties after WW1 blaming Weimar politicians and Jewish people for the loss of the war. Hitler blamed the defeat on his political opponents and from 1919-1923 he began gaining more support [from who?](#) and during that time the Weimar Republic were in a time of crisis, so he orchestrated his first attack. He launched the Munich Beer Hall Putsch (revolt/[coup](#)) on November 8th 1923 [in](#) an attempt to seize government when they were most vulnerable. ~~He~~ He took over the Beer hall and forced all the leaders to promise to support his cause. He planned to march victoriously in Munich the following day but police dispersed the Nazis, resulting in 4 deaths and the imprisonment of Adolf Hitler. Although this ultimately failed, it left Hitler as a hero in the public's eye [explain the significance of this event for Hitler \(decided he would have to legally/politically gain control of the country\)](#). This laying foundation for his future success. Hitler was sentenced to 5 years in jail but only served a 9-month sentence in prison and during his time in there he wrote the book *Mein Kampf*, translating to 'my struggle', which was a best seller and read nationwide, spreading his ideas and nationalism across the country. ~~During his time in prison the Weimar Republic was working on fixing the economy after the mass hyperinflation in 1923, they evidently achieved their goal and began rebuilding Germany returning everything to normal. This comment is a bit lah-di-dah. What do you mean by 'everything'? what do you mean by 'normal'?~~

[This quote is great but make sure you explain it.](#)

[This event \(Munich Beer Hall Putsch\) was significant to shaping Hitler's motivations and his aims of the Nazi Party because he realised the Party would have to take control of Germany through legal and political means. Hitler realised this after the failed takeover of Germany in 1923 and stated the following.](#)

"Instead of working to achieve power by an armed coup we shall have to hold our noses and enter the Reichstag against the Catholic and Marxist deputies. If outvoting them takes longer than outshooting them, at least the results will be guaranteed by their own Constitution! Any lawful process is slow. But sooner or later we shall have a majority – and after that Germany," Hitler stated while in prison, this showing that his intentions were in fact to rule Germany by use the constitution against the Republic so his actions could eventually be legal.

Upon his return from prison, Hitler decided that he needed to create a different political strategy, one that avoided challenging the authorities with violence and fear. Before any of his plans could be put into action, he had to overcome the Nazi parties ban from government and also reorganise the party as there was power disputes between the leaders. [In e](#)Early 1925 Hitler visited the Prime Minister of Bavaria and convinced him to lift the ban providing they worked within the rules of the democratic system. [Shortl](#)y after the ban was lifted Hitler made a speech to thousands of cheering supporters but during began to sledge Jews, the democratic Republic and Marxists. This resulted in a two-year ban of public speaking which was a major setback for Hitler and the Nazi party.

[Explain why this was a ‘quiet time’ for the Nazi Party \(discuss the successes of the Weimar Republic during this era\)](#)

During this time where he was legally silenced he rallied a group of young, impressionable teens and groomed them into soldiers for later years. Between 1926-1929 it was described as the [quiete](#) time. When the Wall Street Crash occurred the people began to panic as unemployment rates rose and Germany began to regress. The government started to seem powerless in comparison to the worldwide economic crisis. Hitler knew that his time had come. Without Hitler it is likely that the Nazi party would have never been allowed back into government. Even before his time on a worldwide stage, he had large power within Germany with his abilities to manipulate high authority officials, giving him an upper hand. [Provide evidence of the Nazi Party’s results in the Reichstag elections. This gives the reader information about how popular they were/were not.](#)

The Nazi party, led by Hitler made their electoral breakthrough in 1930 when the whole world was in an economic crisis. He combined modern technology, political smarts and intimidation along with violence to gather support and spread his Nazi ideologies nationwide. Hitler encapsulated the attention of an unstable Germany with his enticing public speaking methods. The country was desperate for an immediate change, which he was offering them. The appeal of the Nazi party grew steadily in 1931 and 1932, with membership reaching 450,000, this along with the 400,00 SA and 50,000 SS soldiers caused Hitler’s party to emerge as the largest political party in Germany capturing 37.3% of the vote in 1932. [\(however, he still didn’t have the majority in the Reichstag\)](#) By this time, it was inevitable that Hitler would soon come to power and save the country from political paralysis, and impoverishing economy, cultural anarchy and communism. In January of 1933 Hitler persuaded President Paul von Hindenburg to appoint him as Chancellor as Hitler stated that Germany were out of options [\(could discuss that Hindenburg actually distrusted Hitler and the Nazis and tried to appoint other people as Chancellor, however, they were unpopular and he ran out of options\)](#). Following this Hitler began laying foundations for a Nazi state, he took every opportunity possible to turn Germany into a one party dictatorship. German

president Paul von Hindenburg passed away in August 1934, and soon after this Hitler secured the support of the army and abolished presidency and declared himself Fuhrer of Germany. [Make sure you mention how he used Article 48 here.](#) All the military and civilians swore an oath of personal loyalty to Hitler. He was motivated to expand the dominant race of German people and terminate all others who posed any threats towards him. He single handily rallied an entire nation to support his seemingly ludicrous ideas, by causing much of the nation to fall in love with him. Without his leadership Germany may have continued to regress and the great depression would have effected them more severely. Hitler deeming himself dictator of Germany was the catalyst for World War 2 and the atrocities that were caused by it. It is important to recognise that although when reviewing history, we see Hitler as a despicable man. Despite the fact that the majority of Germany are in contradiction of this as they idolised him and offered their full support, in history there is not a large amount of cases where someone with a mindset such as Hitler's, could have caused such momentous change considering his brutality, and have still maintained the support of so many.

"His 'career' was truly astonishing. In the first half of his life he was an absolute nobody. In the second half he made the world hold its breath and wrought destruction on Europe unmatched even by Attila the Hun." Historian Ian Kershaw stated this, displaying insight to his self-made glory, showing that although he is now despised, he once had the entire world and all of humanity under his control. [Great quote, Ian Kershaw is recognised as one of the most important historians for Nazi Germany.](#)

[You should probably discuss what he did after he became Fuhrer. What happened in Germany from 1934 to 1939? Can also discuss the Night of the Long Knives as Hitler's way of eradicating opposition. Discuss the aims of the Nazi Party \(Lebensraum etc.\)](#)

In September 1939 Adolf Hitler ordered troops to invade Poland, this marking the beginning of the Second World War and the death of over 6 million Jewish people. He continued to invade Denmark, Norway, Belgium and Holland within the first year of war. The term Holocaust is used to describe the systematic mass genocide of millions of Jewish people ordered by Hitler and executed by the Nazis. Hitler viewed Jewish people not as a race but a poison to society, after war broke out, the Nazis shifted from expelling Jews from German-controlled territories to exterminating them, he set up concentration camps and began executing them after depriving them of basic human necessities, they were gassed, shot and treated like animals. Hitler had a significant impact as leader as he guided millions of people to justify mass genocide and support him without question. He orchestrated the most historically devastating time period, and was the most powerful and notorious dictator of the 20th century. World War Two caused over 41 million civilian and military deaths, under Hitler's leadership, he legalised murder and changed civilisation. As well as being fuelled by his hatred of communism and Jewish people it is also reported that Hitler took hard drugs which in effect changed the way he thought which many historians and extremists use to justify his actions. Although Hitler is the face of the Holocaust and Nazi Germany is having been recognised that he was easily manipulated by his high authority army officials and was often unaware of many of the decisions being made by them. So although he has all the power he was sometimes seemingly powerless and on more occasions than one ordered the execution of his own men when he discovered they were conspiring behind his back. The war outcome was in favour of Germany in their allies for the first few years, until United

stated entered and Hitler was over confident in his military capability and underestimated the allies (Britain, USA and France). The war came to a conclusion in 1945 following Hitler's suicide. Concentration camps were demobilised but the effects on the Jewish people are everlasting. The Germans no longer has anyone to follow and were lost.

Historian Benjamin Carter stated that 'think Adolf Hitler's most important contribution to the world is this: He showed us what unchecked greed, unabashed bigotry, and loathing and hatred for humankind can do. Hitler has given us an example of the worst kind of person, and the worst thing that can happen to humanity.

Hitler had a detrimentally significant role as Fuhrer in Germany causing catastrophic anarchy worldwide not really.... To most now-days in contemporary society he is viewed as a nationalistic, vicious dictator who ordered, executed and caused the most historically damaging World War – and atrocities within Germany itself. To many others Adolf Hitler is seen as an icon, a beautiful charismatic man who wasn't in the wrong and was protecting a pure race to who??. His actions had an everlasting effect globally, he is such a significant figure, because upon review of his lifetime it is incomprehensible that one man could unite an entire country with such close minded and racist ideas and cause them to support the genocide of over 6 million people. In terms of Hitler contribution to the success of Germany, it is clear he had their interest as a priority, which is a part of human nature. Leaders often lack the consideration of morality towards other nations. The concept of peace is desired but almost impossible to achieve, Hitler understood this, and although creating a war is in complete contraction of the idea of peace, he was attesting to create his own peace. Following World War one there was no balance with the world, each state was seeking solutions at the cost of other nations. This in combination with the rise of power of Hitler at that time, the war was finally broke out. Hitler manipulated all Germans to think like him, they collectively thought that winning this war would create world peace, his significance during his time as leader from 1933-1945 speaks for itself as he will forever be a colossal aspect that is studied within history as he contributed to shaping the world to its current state.